



The Fables of Flynn — The Complete Saga & Timeline

Contents

Part I — The Story

Part II — The Master Timeline

Part III — The Threads Still Open

Part IV — Glossary of Characters, Factions, Places & Things

Part I — The Story

A Machine Older Than the Sword Coast

Long before Waterdeep raised its towers, the empire of **Netheril** floated in the sky, lifted by *mythallars* — great orbs of raw magical energy. The youngest and most gifted mage ever named to the Netherese High Council, **Archmage Carrolyn del Thrysten**, earned his fame by building a

mythallar powerful enough to raise the floating city of **Larkspur** with only a single death to pay for it.

Del Thrysten's closest companion was no mortal. **Dante Saturnid**, the Orphan Prince of Dreams and Archfey of Sweet Slumber, had been cursed by the Queen of Air and Darkness into the shape of a child and exiled to a Netherese boarding school. There the fey trickster and the human prodigy became lifelong colleagues — Dante teaching Carrolyn illusions and dreams, Carrolyn drawing Dante deeper into Netherese magecraft and politics.

Not everyone trusted the mythallars. The proud **House of Wingsong** — warriors and wizards both, a mortal noble line — warned that the orbs led to evils the empire could not survive. For saying so they were quietly exiled from Larkspur *before* Karsus ever worked his folly, driven to the empire's western borders, where they befriended the elves of Neverwinter Wood and raised **Wingsong Manor** as their seat. Their warning proved true. In **–339 DR**, Karsus's Folly shattered Netheril, and Larkspur fell from the sky. *(Per the Candlekeep Annals: the archwizard Karsus reached for the power of the goddess of magic herself; she gave her life rather than let him hold it, and was reborn as Mystra. Arcane magic itself briefly died with her — which the Annals name as the true cause of Netheril's fall from the sky.)*

The Making of a Prison

Del Thrysten survived, and with Dante's help he led the shattered survivors of Larkspur west — to Wingsong Manor, the one roof still standing that could shelter them. What began as a plea for refuge did not stay one for long. Over the following decade the archmage's ambition outgrew his gratitude: by **–328 DR** he had besieged the manor outright, claimed it for his own, and begun repurposing it, stone and spell, into what history would come to call **Wingsong Tower**. Dante's illusions hid the transformed keep from Netherese enemies while del Thrysten secured the surviving mythallar in its Anchor Chamber. What began as a refuge became, over decades, a horror of the archmage's own making.

He built the **Infinite Planar Cyclor** — a machine that fed on the "dipolar" energies of two demiplanes he tore open: a **Feywild** side and a **Shadowfell** side. To power it he needed two living poles. Dante, his oldest friend, became the light pole, forced into a deep slumber. For the dark pole he raised the **Macroscian** — a "Long Shadow," a skeleton enthralled by necromancy and fed living flesh until it swelled into a ravenous monstrosity. Between these two anchored beings, the tower produced a limitless pool of mana — and began flickering endlessly through planes and time.

In his siege of the manor, del Thrysten murdered its defender, **Lord Val'Orea Wingsong** — the mortal head of her house, not the couatl she was once believed to be. *(Emporium Conservatory*

archives: this was a common early misreading of the Wingsong Tower record, since a band of couatl-blooded monks were turned away from the gates that very same year, seeking their lost lord. But those monks — the ancient order that would become the **Knights of Wingsong** — had been in commission long before House Wingsong ever existed, an order of Jazirian's servants that only later took the family's name and cause as their own. Val'Orea, whatever grace or favor she carried, was flesh and blood like the rest of her line.) He turned the monks away and told them their lord was dead. He fought off the Shadovar when the goddess **Shar** sent them hunting the tower, then sealed its doors forever. (Per the Candlekeep Annals: Shar sheltered a whole Netherese enclave, Thultanthar — the City of Shade — within the Shadowfell at the empire's fall. Its Shadovar people would not return openly to Faerûn for well over a thousand years, which the Conservatory's scholars believe explains why Shar's interest in Wingsong Tower went quiet for so long.) By –250 DR he had lost control of his own creation; the tower's warring magics drove him mad, and across the centuries he decayed into a **Nothic**, scribbling mad ramblings into journals no one would read for a thousand years.

Flynn and the Wish

Centuries later, a wizard out of Neverwinter named **Finnegan Flynn** was building a dream of his own: the **Emporium of Wonders**, a place to collect and study all magic. Roughly five years before the present, the Lord's Alliance — through **Sildar Hallwinter** — called him south of Waterdeep to face the **Circle of Flame**, the cult of the fire genasi sorceress **Hariqua Na'Haran**, illegitimate daughter of the Efreeti Sultan of the City of Brass.

Flynn brought his three original companions — **Damien Wingsong, Zoey Drake, and Bastion Drake** — and named the band "the Emporium." They cut through the cult and drove Hariqua into a final duel amid fire and storm on the Trollclaws. But at the decisive moment, Flynn *halted*. Knowing Hariqua's blood carried the reality-binding power of a wish, he traded her freedom — and one wish each from his companions folded into his own — for a single, immense wish, granted atop the hills that very day. What he asked for he has never plainly named — and may not fully know it himself. Publicly, Hariqua "fled" and the cult was "broken." Flynn's reward was a Waterdeep barracks, which he transformed into the Emporium of Wonders and, within five years, into a world-renowned power.

The bargain came due. Back in the City of Brass, the Sultan judged Hariqua weak for trading a wish for her own life. He stripped her efreeti mantle, exiled her to suffer hunger and burns she had never known, then restored her power with a command: "**Conquer Flynn and make Waterdeep suffer.**" She returned to the material plane with a cauldron of everlasting flame and began rebuilding.

The Fables Assemble

The present tale follows a newer band — **the Fables** — recruited into Flynn's orbit.

- **Prologue I – The Oni of Tyl Myerda:** Bastion hired the halfling rogue **Ty'Ny De'Ath** and a human fighter. They seized a pirate ship (gaining a strange bird companion), sailed to the magic-banning isle of Tyl Myerda, slew an Oni masquerading as the Lord Justice, and secured a provisions contract for the Emporium.
- **Prologue II – Hunting Flames:** Ty'Ny recruited the blue-skinned druid **Kaladin Tempest**. Together they destroyed a Cult of Flame acolyte cell and its summoned salamander near Inndale, delivering the corpse to the Emporium for study.

Then came **Book One**. The Fables were formally hired and met Flynn's Three Companions. In **Phandalin** they broke the **Redbrands**, unmasked **Iarno "Glasstaff" Albrek** (mind-controlled by the drow **Nezznar, the Black Spider**), rescued Sildar Hallwinter, and located the lost **Mines of Phandelver**. In **Wave Echo Cave** they wrested the mine from the Black Spider outright.

At the **Soulfire Forge**, the Fables met Hariqua Na'Haran herself and her reborn Cult of Flame — an encounter bound up with the tragedy at **Thornhold Keep**. Hariqua's assault fell first on the keep's dwarven garrison, the shield dwarves who had held Thornhold's underground halls for generations; she slaughtered them where they stood, meaning to claim the fortress above as her own. The Fables and the Emporium arrived in time to break her siege — not in time to save the dwarves. *(Per the Candlekeep Annals: those were the shield dwarves of Clan Stoneshaft, who had dwelt in caverns beneath Thornhold — reached by a passage into the Underdark — since long before the keep changed hands to the Zhentarim in 1368 DR. That their long stewardship should end at a fire genasi's hand struck the Conservatory's scholars as a bitter, final page to a very old story.)* With Hariqua driven off and no dwarves left to reclaim their ancestral hold, the Emporium's claim to Thornhold went uncontested.

Once the Fables had battled Hariqua to a standstill and sent her fleeing back to the Fire Plane, **Flynn himself arrived** — and in a rare display of his own considerable might, laid low the hidden caverns of the Circle of Flame outright. He claimed the **Soulfire Forge** itself as a prize of war, an artifact of fire magic potent enough to be worth a wizard's personal attention. They chased the necromancer **Hamun Kost**, a Red Wizard of Thay who had murdered Moira'Val's master **Peer'Na** to steal a book studying Wingsong Tower and a species of firefly that could reveal it. Kost now rots in Thornhold's dungeons; his patron, they learned, had been **Halia Thornton** of the Zhentarim.

Into the Dark — and Bastion's Ledger

The hunt for the tower drove the Fables into the **Underdark**, chasing the fireflies before the Zhentarim could. It is at this juncture that **Bastion's private notes to Flynn** capture the Emporium's true, unvarnished situation:

- **Hariqua** has retreated to the Fire Plane and the Sultan's court; Damien's study of her soul-powered forge confirms its "devilish" nature. Making an enemy of the entire Fire Plane would be ruinous — Bastion counsels a subtler path and has the **Harpers** listening.
- The **Zhentarim and the Red Wizards of Thay** are racing the Emporium for the same prize. Halia is confirmed dead; her successor is unknown. The Black Network wants to buy the Emporium's loyalty or seize it whole — and its hunger for Wingsong Tower forces the Emporium to move against it.
- **Thornhold's** reconstruction proceeds under a Lord's Alliance lease, but the cost in dwarven lives — the Stoneshaft garrison Hariqua put to the sword — was steep, the **Wimbleblats** are turning Waterdeep against them, and Baldur's Gate has soured (Neverwinter still loves them).
- The **Emporium** is expanding along the Sword Coast and Triboar Trail toward five times its Waterdeep capacity. **Zoey Drake and Gypsa are below decks overseeing the engineering of the captured Soulfire Forge into the flying ship** — no mystery, simply occupied. Bastion's real appeal to Flynn is for help managing **Elminster and Lady Silverhand**, whose scrutiny of the Emporium is mounting. *"I may need your help."*

In the Underdark they found **Hideaway Bay**, the last deep gnomes of drowned Tingstone. In exchange for a new home at Thundertree, the gnomes shared the firefly lore — and the brilliant young engineer **Gypsa** would go on to captain the Fables' skyship.

But Thundertree had to be won first. The ruined village was held by a **young green dragon** — one of Hariqua Na'Haran's own cult allies. (*Emporium Conservatory archives, filed by Beratrymus Villium: Thundertree stood empty and wild since Mount Hotenow's eruption devastated the Neverwinter region a generation past — precisely the kind of abandoned ruin a young dragon would claim as its own. The Conservatory's notes even venture a name for the beast: Venomfang.*) With the region already calmer after the Fables' earlier rout of the Zhentarim's grip on Phandalin, the druid **Kaladin Tempest** led the retaking of Thundertree, and the Fables slew the dragon. The victory both gave the deep gnomes a peaceful place to settle and cut away one of the Circle of Flame's alliances.

Plague, Tower, and Return

At **Larkspur Heath**, the Fables found the great **Library** sealed by **Sir Bently Rhammer** on the orders of **Lord Neebo Wimbleblat**, its librarians dying of a mystery poison. The confrontation

turned to slaughter: Rhammer fell, the disgraced ex-chancellor **Newton Filz** was exposed as a Zhentarim agent and killed, and the poison was traced to Wimbleblat-marked supplies. The librarians were healed and raised. *(Per the Candlekeep Annals: raising the dead has lately been no simple matter across Faerûn — a death curse elsewhere in the world has been known to turn resurrection magic hollow. That the Larkspur librarians rose at all, the Conservatory notes, may say something quiet about Flynn's own hand in the working.)*

At last the Fables reached **Wingsong Tower**. They passed through its Fey and Shadow demiplanes and its Anchor Chamber, and there vanquished the **Macroscian** — the Long Shadow — to close the Shadowfell tear. The moment it toppled, something in the chamber changed: an apparition rose where the creature had stood, wearing **Val'Orea Wingsong's** face. *(Emporium Conservatory archives: the likeliest theory — never confirmed, only ever offered — is that some fragment of Val'Orea's memory had been trapped within the Macroscian's own gestations since the night it killed her, and was only loosed when the thing was finally destroyed.)* The figure was no ghost of Val'Orea herself, though — it was the **Raven Queen**, borrowing that face to speak. She explained little of herself or her purposes, but she gave two things freely. First, a truth: that both **Moirra'Val and Pim** carried Wingsong blood in their lineage, kin by a line neither had known to claim. Second, a gift: a cloak she named the **Mantle of the Raven Queen**, bestowed on **Ty'Ny** — and with it, a charge rather than a command. She asked the halfling rogue to uphold her ethos: to slay the undead, and to stand against any shadow that would bend death's power to infernal ends. Then, almost in passing, she asked one more thing — that the Fables send her greetings to **Flynn**, the next time they spoke with him, in the easy tone of someone who had known him a very long time.

The mad archmage **del Thrysten** finally met his end at the hands of his oldest friend, **Dante**, now awakened as Pim's fey companion. The Fables escaped with the **Mythallar** of ancient Larkspur — and though the Zhentarim, encircling the tower, seized **Lord Damien Wingsong and two Knights of Wingsong**, the Fables broke the encirclement and freed them, carrying all three safely home. It is **Damien and his knights** — the ancient couatl order sworn to the tower — who carry couatl nature; **Moirra'Val and Pim**, by contrast, descend from the mortal Wingsong bloodline itself, and Moirra'Val now carries its birthright.

The Knights, the Bloodline, and Who Flynn Really Is

Two conversations reframe everything the Fables thought they knew.

Speaking with Moirra'Val, **Damien** admitted he does not carry Wingsong blood at all. The **Order of the Knights of Wingsong** — an ancient couatl order sworn to Jazirian's cause — had stood watch for a thousand years before House Wingsong ever existed, and only later took the family's name and purpose as its own. When Damien came to believe the true bloodline had finally died

out in the long shadow of Karsus's Folly, he took up the Wingsong name and its two charges himself, out of devotion rather than birthright: first, to gather and keep the Mythallars safe; second, **to protect and serve Flynn**. He does not yet know that a true heir still walks beside him — for Flynn has appeared throughout history as different people, Damien revealed, not quite reincarnation, he said, but close enough. The roughly 110 years he'll own to are how long he has worn the name Damien Wingsong and this dragonborn shape — not how long he has kept his vigil, nor how long he has been utterly devoted to Flynn, trusting him to guard the world from the Mythallars' power.

Then, upon the Fables' return, **Flynn offered clarity of his own** — and it was staggering. The Mythallars, he explained, were never merely engines of flight. In building them the archmagi of Netheril (and their elven counterparts) cleaved the very fabric of magic, matter, and time, fraying the Weave with every cut. That same power let them lock the faery prince Dante in eternal sleep and lift cities into the sky — and it tore open a loophole in the **Pact Primordial**, the ancient agreement of creation, for **Asmodeus** to exploit.

Flynn confessed his true nature: he is not a man but a **living dream of Jazirian**, the primordial couatl-deity of law, light, and mercy — a figment sent to walk the world across many lives and learn from its passions. **Asmodeus** — who also hides beneath the name **Ahriman** — is Jazirian's twin sibling, now sitting injured in the pits of **Baator**, scheming to unmake the world and refashion the broken Pact to his sole will. **Shar**, Flynn says, is Asmodeus's shadow; Jazirian has such shadows too. The Knights of Wingsong are only the most recent of those who have learned to seek Flynn out across the ages — before them, the cloaked wizards of a certain Neverwinter tower (now Owl's Roost).

Worst of all: when **Hariqua Na'Haran** tried to twist Flynn's Wish to her own ends, she unwittingly re-forged a bond of patronage between Flynn and his fiendish sibling. Flynn now fears he has pulled Asmodeus deeper into his designs than is safe — that the archfiend shares once more in power that was long ago split between them.

And Flynn confessed what the Wish had truly been for. Its exact workings are clouded — veiled, perhaps, by divine power or by the laws primordial themselves — but its intent he could name: he had wished for **access to Ahriman's own power**, gambling that a measure of his brother's strength would let him act faster than the archfiend and mend the Pact before Asmodeus could seize it. He had not gone in unprepared: for years, in a private research dimension, he had studied fiends, devils, and beholders — beings whose powers run closest to his brother's — both to ready himself for the Wish and to learn how the **Negative Energy Plane** might warp the gifts of one who, as a dream of Jazirian, is tied to pure **positive energy**. Yet something did not work as intended. Flynn now suspects a **missing fulcrum** to the twinned powers he and his brother embody — some

balancing point that neither of them yet holds. For the moment the bond cuts strangely in his favor: while the Wish links the siblings for the first time in an epoch, it also keeps Flynn **hidden from Ahriman's devilish sight**. And in the space between the two of them, Flynn senses something — or someone — foreboding, standing unseen between the brothers.

Flynn's wager, and his hope, is that neither he nor his sibling remain the beings who first made that pact: that Asmodeus has become more archfiend than creator, and Jazirian more archangel of healing than cold law. He urges the Emporium to move with urgency — but not haste — to mend the Pact before their enemies grasp what is truly at stake.

Bastion, meanwhile, lays out the choices ahead, naming five gathering storms: a chaotic **gray mist over the Silver Marches**; the sudden emergence of the **Zhentarim's leader, the Peregost**; the **Well of Dragons** gone active, its smoke blinding the Emporium's many eyes; **Baldur's Gate** drowning in blood and murder as the names of the **Dead Three** spread and war with **Amn** looms to the south; and **Shar**, dancing at the very edge of sight for reasons no one can yet fathom.

Aboard the flaming, battered **Fables' Fortune**, under Gypsa's piloting, the band returns at last to **Thornhold** — now dwarfed by Flynn's ever-growing citadel. With them ride the rescued **Lord Damien Wingsong and his two knights** — couatls of the ancient order that bears the Wingsong name, freed from the Zhentarim. They carry more than the Mythallar: Ty'Ny bears the **Mantle of the Raven Queen** and her charge to hunt the undead and the shadow that wields them; Moira'Val carries the Wingsong birthright, and knows now that Pim shares her blood; Salihafa hears his god clearly; Kaladin wields new elemental mastery (and the Mythallar itself, riding in a druid's rucksack); and Dante travels as a great moth beside Pim. Behind them drift fell winds — Shar's gaze, and the Zhentarim seeking their arrest in the name of Waterdeep's nobility. Zoey and Bastion wait at Flynn's side, and the search for the *next* lost Mythallar is only beginning.

Four Hands, One Wonder: How Flynn, Damien, Bastion, and Zoey Built the Emporium

With the barracks bought and the doors of the Emporium of Wonders newly hung, Flynn had a vision fixed in his mind — a place to collect and study all magic, and, in time, a citadel worthy of guarding it. A vision, however grand, cannot mortar itself, negotiate its own trade routes, stand a watch, or hold a household together. That work fell, as it always would, to the three who had followed him out of Neverwinter and never once needed to be asked twice — though one of them, in truth, had been following him a great deal longer than that.

Damien was never meant to recruit mercenaries or sign trade agreements, and never has. What he brought to the Emporium cannot be itemized in Bastion's ledgers or drawn on Zoey's fortification plans, though the whole enterprise leans on it more than either: heart, and loyalty, and a fairness

that has never once bent under pressure from either side of an argument. He is fair and kind, strong and gentle, and he commands the Knights of Wingsong with that same impossible balance — a knight commander who has never needed to raise his voice to be obeyed, because his knights have simply never doubted that his judgment is sound. He is, by a wide margin, the oldest of Flynn's three companions. Those who spend enough time in his company come away with the quiet, half-spoken suspicion that he holds more wisdom and lived experience than even the wondrous Flynn — a suspicion none of them can quite prove, and none of them are wrong to have. The roughly hundred and ten years he'll admit to, if pressed, are how long he has worn this name and this dragonborn shape. They are not how long he has been watching.

For Damien found Flynn before Flynn was born this time. He and his secret couatl knighthood had been watching the potential for longer than any mortal record could easily account for, and it was Damien and his Knights who stood guard the night Flynn was reborn into the world he now walks. What that night held, and what it cost, is a story for another time — Damien has never told it in full even to Bastion or Zoey, and Flynn himself, when the subject rises, only ever goes quiet and lets his oldest companion decide how much of it deserves daylight. It is enough, for now, to know that Damien's loyalty to Flynn did not begin at a barracks in Merchant Square. It began before there was a Flynn there to be loyal to, and has never once wavered since.

That same patient devotion is what actually raised Bastion and Zoey. Flynn never formally adopted them — they kept the Drake name, their own family's name, and are proudly no one's wards — but he funded their private education in Neverwinter and, now that both have grown into their thirty-second year, treats them as members of his chosen family and equals in full. It was Damien, though, who was *present* for the raising itself — who taught a young, restless Zoey that strength without restraint is just another kind of recklessness, and taught a cleverer, more slippery Bastion that charm spent without loyalty behind it eventually charms no one at all. The twins seem to have inherited a piece of each man for it: Flynn's endless youthfulness and flair show in both of them still, more than three decades in, while it's Damien's reserve and quiet strength that surfaces the moment either twin stops performing and starts deciding something that actually matters. Neither twin would put any of this in quite those words. Both of them, without exception, still go to Damien first when a decision actually frightens them, and both know better than to lie to him about why.

Flynn gave the vision and the coin, and — rarely, but memorably — his own considerable might: the caverns of the Circle of Flame laid low in a single afternoon; a formal charter of protection handed to the resettled gnomes of Thundertree with no strings attached; a Waterdeep barracks transformed, in five years, into a name spoken with the same weight as Waterdeep or Neverwinter themselves. He is the reason any of it was possible. He is also, by his own household's quiet

agreement, the one member of it least suited to actually building anything — a fact Damien has known, and gently forgiven him for, since long before Flynn knew it about himself.

Bastion built the trade. He doesn't advertise; he *notices* — the dwarven stoneworkers of a failing Yartar quarry before their guild could scatter them to worse employers, the glaziers of a burned-out Waterdeep workshop starving for a patron, the smiths who could work Netherese-touched ore without it souring in their hands. Each got the same pitch over the same excellent wine: not a job, but a place in something that would outlast them. The same instinct built the Emporium's whole regional web. In **Phandalin**, first proof of concept, he brokered the claim on Barthen's old warehouse, funded the Phandelver Field Research Outpost, and quietly underwrote Toblen Stonehill's rise to council chair. Along the Triboar Trail's ruined stretch at **Conyberry**, a handful of resettled families got a stipend for a mill and a well in exchange for nothing but a waystation flying no flag. At **Triboar** itself he made himself indispensable to two rival towns at once — Triboar and long-quarreling **Yartar** both — offering each the same deal and letting neither know the other had it too; it was here, chasing Hamun Kost's trail, that the Fables first saw how far his paper trail already reached ahead of them. **Thundertree's** deep gnomes became not just a rescue but a trade partnership, their clockwork exported through Emporium hands to Waterdeep nobles who have no idea where their finest mechanisms are actually made. **Larkspur Heath's** Library was rebuilt as a sister house to the Emporium's own Atheneum, its supply line something Bastion never lets run short. And **Tyl Myerda**, a magic-wary island, was won over by not being asked to change at all — the Emporium helped formalize the isle's own laws rather than override them, and the elders still speak of "Bastion the bard" fondly, with no particular reason to know he never stopped working while he sang.

That same talent-gathering instinct built **Southwall** from bare ground in under two years — a real village, not a construction camp, pressed against Thornhold's south wall at the foot of the thorn the old keep crowns, close enough that on quiet nights its three hundred workers can hear the citadel's masons still at labor above them. At its heart stands **The Wayfarer**, the town's true center of gravity, run by a broad, easy-smiling man named **Parker Peterson** — found by Bastion keeping a threadbare roadside inn on the Triboar Trail and simply asked, *how would you like a bigger room to be generous in?* Parker said yes before the sentence finished, and every worker in Southwall will tell you he's the finest innkeeper on the High Road. What they're less sure of is why the stout never tastes quite the same twice, always somehow exactly what the room needed that night, or who's really playing the music that never seems to stop. Parker doesn't know the tiefling who charmed him out of his old life still visits some nights uninvited, and never once takes credit for the song already playing when he sits down.

Zoey built the wall — and everything the wall was built to protect. Where her brother meanders, Zoey strides with purpose; where Bastion charms an answer out of someone over an

hour of wine, Zoey simply tells them the truth and lets it land. She is, by any honest account, the equal of Bastion's talents and the stronger of the two twins besides — an engineer and a battle tactician in the same body, which is a rarer combination than either skill alone. The **Serpent Mercenaries** did not exist five years ago; she built their rank structure, their training, their discipline from nothing, and it is her lieutenants, not Lord's Alliance agents, who answer the call when trouble reaches Phandalin's Triboar Trail cutoff or the roads to Triboar and Yartar. Thornhold's reconstruction may draw on Bastion's laborers, but its walls, its garrison rotations, its sightlines and killing floors are Zoey's own design — a citadel is only as good as the people who can hold it, and she has made sure Flynn's can be held.

Her sharpest triumph, though, she shares with a friend. **Gypsa** — the deep gnome engineer who led the Fables out of the Underdark and now captains the *Fables' Fortune* — found in Zoey an unlikely kindred spirit, and the two of them became fast friends practically the moment the ship's keel needed real work done to it. Where Zoey is blunt and Gypsa is bright, the two fit together the way a hammer fits a chisel; more than one Serpent has remarked that Gypsa's sheer, undimmed joy has been the only tonic that reliably softens Zoey's edges, and that Zoey, in turn, is the only person who takes Gypsa's wilder engineering schemes seriously enough to actually help her build them. It was that partnership that turned Flynn's captured **Soulfire Forge** from a war trophy into the *Fortune's* beating heart, retrofitted for raw firepower and flight speed neither of them could have managed alone. Ask Zoey what she's proudest of building in five years, and she won't say the walls. She'll say the ship, and she'll say Gypsa's name in the same breath without noticing she's done it.

The Citadel Rising is what all four of them add up to. Thornhold is no longer merely leased ground — it is the place where Flynn's vision, Damien's steadiness, Bastion's trade, and Zoey's walls all converge into something none of them could have built apart. The old keep and its walls, the Thornhold the Fables first found, sit eastward now, hunched and humble at the thorn's shoulder, closest to the High Road and the travelers who still arrive that way — for the true Citadel has been raised at the very peak of the promontory, out over the western cliff edge and the sea below, until the original fortress looks less like a stronghold and more like a gatehouse to something far greater. (*Per the Candlekeep Annals: Thornhold's hill has always dropped away to a seaside cliff on its western face, with the High Road running along its eastern approach — a detail the Emporium's own builders kept faithfully when they raised the Citadel at the hill's western peak, over the sea, rather than displacing the old keep that still guards the road.*) Pale stone rises in ribbed, scalloped domes dark as slate against the sky, crowned with spires hung with long banners bearing the Emporium's ten-pointed star; grand stairways and terraced plazas step down the cliff face from the citadel's crown all the way to Southwall's rooftops, so that a worker leaving the Wayfarer at dusk can look west and watch Flynn's wonder catch the last of the light

before anything below does. Its reconstruction employs laborers drawn from every village up and down the High Road, now drawing Emporium coin rather than a lord's. It houses the Serpent Mercenaries' true seat, a standing force answerable to no crown, and the Knights of Wingsong besides, watching over it all with the same patience Damien has always had.

Beneath it all, within the cliffs themselves, run the old passages and dwarven halls the Stoneshafes once called home — secret ways Zoey has quietly re-warded and re-walled rather than sealed. Most lead nowhere anymore. One still descends, uninterrupted, into the Underdark far below, watched at all hours by a standing rotation of Zoey's own Serpent Mercenaries — a post she trusts to no one else. And one other opens outward rather than down: a hidden cavern the tunnels break open into, vast and unlit until torches catch it, its far wall simply *gone* — a sheer, open cliffside looking out over the western sea, wide and tall enough to swallow the *Fables' Fortune* whole with room to spare. It is here, behind stone no map admits to and a cliff face no ship's lookout would ever think to search, that the Fables have made their true headquarters — closer to the Citadel's heart than even Flynn's own chambers, and known to fewer people besides. Its own doors are watched just as closely, though by different eyes: **Glorn** the spectator and his keeper **Ben Pendragon** stand guard there, letting nothing pass that Flynn hasn't already forgiven. Within, among the storerooms, a familiar face keeps the books: **Gerk**, once Phandalin's town clerk, left that quiet post to become the Fables' own Quartermaster and banker, and has lived in the caverns below the Citadel ever since — closer to the ledgers than to daylight, and happier for it. And Flynn's citadel rises above the old keep's walls a little higher every season, not hidden, not apologized for, simply *there*, the way Waterdeep's own towers are there.

None of it was seized. Every mile of it was given, freely, by people the Emporium helped when no one else would. That is precisely what worries Elminster and Lady Silverhand more than any army could. A conquered land can be liberated. A land that *loves* its conqueror has no reason to want to be.

The Shadow: Wimbleblat's Confederation

Lord Neebo Wimbleblat did not survive Larkspur Heath by being reckless twice. House Wimbleblat has stood among Waterdeep's magecraft nobility for generations — not so storied as House Wands, whose towers still bear the founder's name, but old enough, and proud enough, that its fortunes were built on the same currency: fine artifice, sold to a city that has always paid well for wonders. The constructs Sir Bently Rhammer commanded at the Library's doors were Wimbleblat make, every one — clever, beautiful, murderous work, utterly deniable once their maker was safely back behind Sea Ward walls when the killing was traced. The killing *was* traced, and Rhammer and Filz both paid for it. Neebo did not. He simply stopped fighting the war he'd already lost and started the one he could win.

Where the Circle of Flame's echo had been poison and constructs, Wimbleblat's second campaign is paperwork, patronage, and the long memory of a class that never forgives being made to look the fool by a man who "arrived from nowhere five years ago." He has built a **confederation** — old houses whose fortunes have thinned in exact proportion to the Emporium's rise. House Wands, whose magecraft once had no rival in the city and never fully recovered what the Spellplague burned out of them, needs no convincing that a barracks-turned-museum has no business outshining a house a thousand years older. Others in the confederation guard debts and secrets Bastion suspects run considerably darker than wounded pride — soft talk of certain Sea Ward galas where guests leave wealthier and stranger than they arrived, of a family whose children are never quite seen in daylight. He has not confirmed it. He has not stopped listening either.

The confederation's weapons are entirely legal, which is what makes them dangerous: a year spent lobbying the **Watchful Order of Magists and Protectors** for a formal inquiry into the Emporium's "unlicensed proliferation of dangerous magical assets"; the careful, deniable courting of the city's anonymous **Masked Lords**, one at a time, into a bloc that needs no author; rival trade offers aimed squarely at Triboar, Yartar, and Larkspur's restored Library, all timed to bleed the Emporium's goodwill exactly when it can least afford to look weak. Bastion has not lost a single one of those fights yet — not by matching Wimbleblat blow for blow, but by refusing to fight on the terms Neebo assumes he must. He invited the Watchful Order's scrutiny rather than resisting it. He answered the confederation's gold to Triboar and Yartar by simply reminding both towns that Serpent escorts had already ridden out for them for a year without asking anything back. He has quietly begun assembling his own dossier on the confederation's members and has, so far, used none of it. Whether that restraint is virtue or patience, even Zoey isn't sure.

Elminster and Laeral watch all of this and say almost nothing to Wimbleblat at all — not because Neebo is wrong, but because the confederation is asking them to rule against family, and they have never quite been able to think of Flynn any other way. Laeral scolds him like the son she never had time to raise properly; Elminster needles him like a father worried a clever boy is about to be cleverer than is good for him. It was Elminster, not Wimbleblat, who said the truest thing anyone has said about the Emporium all year — *if you are pinned, the next move will be the skewer* — and he said it to Flynn's face, in private, the way you warn someone you love rather than someone you're prosecuting. Flynn has never called Elminster anything so plain as *father*. He doesn't have to. It's there in the way he goes quiet and actually listens — the one voice in the world he never once tries to charm.

So Laeral's authority as Open Lord has, so far, kept Wimbleblat's confederation from becoming an official censure, and Elminster's private warnings have kept Flynn from a few mistakes he might otherwise have made in the dark. But neither of them has told Wimbleblat he's wrong to worry.

The two people who love Flynn most are beginning, quietly, to wonder what he'll do the day loving him is no longer enough to keep him honest.

Part II — The Master Timeline

Compiled by the Emporium Conservatory from Bastion's own ledgers, cross-referenced against Candlekeep's copied scrolls. Rows marked *✦* are wider-Realms history, not the Fables' own doing — kept here because the two brush against each other more than once.

The Netherese Age (dates in negative DR count *down* to Netheril's fall)

DATE	EVENT
Pre-fall	Carrolyn del Thristen, youngest-ever High Council archmage, builds a mythallar to raise the floating city of Larkspur (one death). Befriends the exiled archfey Dante Saturnid at school.
Pre-fall	House Wingsong — a mortal noble line — opposes further mythallars; exiled west from Larkspur, befriends the elves of Neverwinter Wood, and raises Wingsong Manor as their seat.
–339 DR	Karsus's Folly . Netheril falls; Larkspur crashes at the site of the modern Larkspur Library. ✦ <i>Per the Candlekeep Annals: the goddess of magic gave her life rather than let Karsus hold her power, and was reborn as Mystra — arcane magic itself briefly died with her, the true cause, the Annals say, of Netheril's fall.</i>
–338 DR	Del Thristen & Dante lead Larkspur's shattered survivors west to Wingsong Manor , seeking shelter; Dante's illusions help hide the refugees from Netherese enemies.
–335 DR	The Feywild demiplane is created. Dante and survivors are trapped inside by planar time distortion.
–328 DR	Del Thristen besieges and claims Wingsong Manor , repurposing it into the tower and securing the surviving mythallar in its new Anchor Chamber. The Shadowfell demiplane is made and a Macroscian (Long Shadow) tethered within, fed on survivors. Del Thristen kills the manor's mortal defender, Lord Val'Orea Wingsong . Robed couatl monks — the ancient order that becomes the Knights of Wingsong — are turned away.
–327 DR	The Infinite Planar Cycler is completed; del Thristen forces Dante into deep slumber as the machine's light pole.

DATE	EVENT
–289 DR	Shar sends the Shadovar to find the tower. Del Thristen repels them and locks the doors permanently. 🗡️ <i>Per the Candlekeep Annals: Shar sheltered the Netherese enclave of Thultanthar — the City of Shade — within the Shadowfell at the empire's fall, explaining why her Shadovar vanish from the tower's affairs for a thousand years.</i>
–250 DR	Del Thristen loses control; the tower flickers through planes and time. He spirals into madness.
–221 DR	Del Thristen's journals stop.

The Long Silence

DATE	EVENT
347 DR	Del Thristen resumes his journals — mad ramblings hinting he has become a Nothic .
951 DR	Orc raids empty Tresendar Manor in Phandalin (later the Redbrand hideout).
952 DR	🗡️ <i>Thornhold is raised after the Second Trollwar; the paladin Samular Caradoon routs the warlord Brunyundar Margaster from the keep and makes it a chapterhouse of Tyrran knights.</i> The very keep the Emporium will one day hold has changed hands by war and treaty ever since.
1368 DR	🗡️ <i>The Zhentarim seize Thornhold through an Underdark passage, enslaving the shield dwarves of Clan Stoneshaft who dwell beneath it.</i> Those same Stoneshaft dwarves would, centuries later, be wiped out by Hariqua Na'Haran — an eerie forerunner of the Fables' own Underdark dealings and the Zhentarim's present hunger for what the keep now guards.
1372 DR	🗡️ <i>The Shadovar of Thultanthar — the City of Shade — return openly to Faerûn, ending the millennium of quiet that followed Shar's assault on Wingsong Tower.</i>
1385 DR	The Spellplague stills the tower's magic. Dante blinks awake into a half-controlled dream — later reached by Pim as a child. The same cataclysm drives the deep gnomes of Tingstone into the caves that become Hideaway Bay . 🗡️ <i>Per the Candlekeep Annals: the Spellplague follows the goddess Mystra's murder, and the Weave itself convulses. The Emporium Conservatory's own troubling annotation marks this as the very year Asmodeus is recorded to ascend to full godhood — a coincidence Flynn has never spoken of aloud.</i>
1451 DR	🗡️ <i>Mount Hotenow erupts, devastating Neverwinter and emptying Thundertree — leaving it a ruin free for a young green dragon, and later the deep gnomes, to claim.</i>

DATE	EVENT
1486 DR	☞ <i>Demon lords loose in the Underdark; the Silver Marches endure war and incursion</i> — a plausible root of the gray mist Bastion now watches.
1487 DR	☞ <i>The Second Sundering repairs the broken Weave</i> . Magic in Faerûn steadies again — just before the Emporium's founding.

~5 Years Before Present — The Rise of the Emporium

EVENT
Finnegan Flynn (of Neverwinter) begins building the Emporium of Wonders.
The Lord's Alliance (via Sildar Hallwinter) recruits Flynn against Hariqua Na'Haran's Circle of Flame in the Trollclaws.
Flynn, Damien, Zoey & Bastion drive the cult back. In the final duel, Flynn halts and bargains a wish for Hariqua's freedom.
Publicly the cult is "broken"; Flynn is rewarded a Waterdeep barracks and founds the Emporium of Wonders .
The Sultan punishes Hariqua for the bargain — exile, suffering, then a command to " Conquer Flynn and make Waterdeep suffer. " She rebuilds the Circle of Flame.

The Present Campaign (culminating 1491 DR)

Prologues

1. **The Oni of Tyl Myerda** — Ty'Ny De'Ath & a fighter seize a pirate ship, gain a bird companion, slay the Oni/false Lord Justice, and win a provisions contract.
2. **Hunting Flames** — Ty'Ny & Kaladin destroy a Cult of Flame cell and its salamander near Inndale.

Book One, Part 1

1. Fables hired by the Emporium; meet Flynn's Three Companions.
2. Redbrands broken in Phandalin; Glasstaff & the Black Spider exposed; Hallwinter rescued; Phandelver Mines found.
3. **Wave Echo Cave** — the mine wrested from Nezznar the Black Spider.
4. **The Soulfire Forge** — first clash with Hariqua's reborn cult; the tragedy of Thornhold Keep; Flynn himself lays low the Circle of Flame's caverns and claims the Forge as his prize.

5. **Chasing a Necromancer** — Hamun Kost captured; his Wingsong Tower book and Halia Thornton's Zhentarim ties revealed.
6. **Fireflies in the Underdark** — Hideaway Bay's gnomes aid the search for the tower in exchange for passage to Thundertree. (*Bastion's status memo to Flynn is written at this threshold.*)
 - **Thundertree retaken** — Kaladin leads the assault; the Fables slay the young green dragon holding the village (a Circle of Flame ally), securing a peaceful home for the deep gnomes.
7. **Plague and Treachery at Larkspur Heath** — the poisoned Library saved; Rhammer and the Zhentarim-hired Filz killed; the Wimbleblat plot uncovered. 🐉 *Per the Candlekeep Annals: a death curse abroad in the world has lately made true resurrection rare and costly — which casts a quiet shadow over how easily the Larkspur librarians were raised, and may say something about Flynn's own hand in the working.*
8. **The Search for Wingsong Tower** — the tower found and escaped with the Mythallar; the Long Shadow slain; del Thrysten killed by Dante; Damien and two knights briefly seized by the Zhentarim, then rescued by the Fables and returned safely to Thornhold.

Book One, Part 2

1. **The Fables Return** — the band returns to Thornhold bearing the Mythallar and the rescued Damien and his two knights (couatls of the ancient order that bears the Wingsong name). Transformed: Ty'Ny (the Mantle of the Raven Queen, and her charge against the undead and shadow), Moira'Val (Wingsong birthright, and news that Pim shares her blood), Kaladin (elemental mastery, carrying the Mythallar), Salihafa (his god's voice), Pim & the awakened Dante.
 - **Flynn Offers Clarity:** Flynn reveals he is a living dream of the primordial **Jazirian**; **Asmodeus/Ahriman** is his sibling; the Mythallars fractured the **Pact Primordial**; and Hariqua's meddling with his Wish re-bound him to Asmodeus. The Wish itself sought **access to Ahriman's power** to outpace him — but it misfired, hinting at a **missing fulcrum**. For now the bond hides Flynn from Ahriman's sight, with something foreboding standing between them.
 - **Bastion Offers Choices:** five threats named — the Silver Marches gray mist, the Zhentarim's leader (**the Peregost**), the active **Well of Dragons**, blood in **Baldur's Gate** with the **Dead Three** rising and war with **Amn** looming, and **Shar** at the edge of sight. 🐉 *Per the Candlekeep Annals: the Well of Dragons is where the Cult of the Dragon gathers to raise Tiamat herself — likely the true source of the smoke blinding the Emporium's foresight. The Annals also whisper that Elturel, near Baldur's Gate, has been dragged*

bodily into Avernus, Asmodeus's own dominion — if true, a closer shadow of Ahriman than Flynn has admitted.

Part III — The Threads Still Open

The cosmic stakes

- **Flynn / Jazirian vs. Asmodeus:** Flynn seeks to mend the **Pact Primordial** the Mythallars broke. His wager is that he and his sibling have both changed — but Hariqua's tampering with his Wish has re-tethered him to Asmodeus, who now shares power he shouldn't. The whole search for lost Mythallars serves this end.
- **The missing fulcrum & the figure between:** Flynn's Wish sought access to **Ahriman's power** to outpace his brother — but it misfired. He suspects a **missing fulcrum** to their twinned natures, and senses someone or something foreboding standing unseen between the siblings. For now the bond hides him from Ahriman's sight.
- **Shar** dances at the edge of sight — a shadow of Asmodeus, her purpose unknown even to Flynn.
- **The night Flynn was reborn:** Damien and his couatl knighthood watched for Flynn's coming before this incarnation was born, and stood guard the night of that rebirth. Neither Damien nor Flynn has ever told the story in full — a tale for another time.
- **The Raven Queen's greeting:** she spoke of Flynn as an old, familiar acquaintance, and asked the Fables to pass on her greeting the next time they spoke with him. Whether it has been delivered yet, and how Flynn might react to it, remains unknown.

Bastion's five gathering storms

- A chaotic **gray mist over the Silver Marches**, some true power behind it. *(Per the Candlekeep Annals: the Silver Marches have lately seen both an orc-horde war and demon lords loose from the Abyss — either could be the mist's true source.)*
- The **Zhentarim's leader, the Peregost**, has stepped into the open, changing the balance.
- The **Well of Dragons** is active, its smoke blinding the Emporium's foresight. *(Per the Candlekeep Annals: the Well of Dragons is where the Cult of the Dragon gathers to raise Tiamat herself from the Nine Hells — if the smoke is theirs, the storm is graver than Bastion yet knows.)*
- **Baldur's Gate** floods with blood and murder; the **Dead Three** are spoken aloud and war with **Amn** looms south. *(Per the Candlekeep Annals: the Dead Three — Bhaal, Bane, and Myrkul*

— have stirred restless cults in the Gate before; some *Annals*-readers whisper the true danger lies still further off, where the town of *Elturel* was once dragged bodily into *Avernus*, *Asmodeus's* own dominion.)

- **Shar's** unreadable involvement (above).

Nearer troubles

- **Hariqua Na'Haran** is alive on the Fire Plane, cult rebuilt, sworn to ruin Flynn — and the Emporium dreads open war with the entire *Efreeti* court.
- **The Zhentarim & the Red Wizards of Thay** race the Emporium for lost *Mythallars* and seek the *Fables'* arrest through *Waterdeep's* nobility. *Halia's* successor is unknown.
- **Wimbleblat's Confederation** — a legal, deniable political war of inquiries, courted *Masked Lords*, and rival trade offers, waged against the Emporium's regional goodwill. *Bastion* is winning it, so far — and quietly compiling leverage on the confederation's members he still hasn't decided whether to use. Some of what he's heard about certain member houses' *Sea Ward galas* he hasn't dared repeat even to Flynn. *Baldur's Gate* has soured on the Emporium too (*Neverwinter* still loves them).
- **Elminster and Lady Laeral Silverhand** grow warier, fearing the Emporium is "mixing a cauldron of power" no one can safely hold. Managing them is the help *Bastion* actually asks of Flynn. (*Zoey and Gypsa are simply below decks engineering the captured Soulfire Forge into the flying ship — no mystery there.*)

The road ahead

- **The next Mythallar.** How many *Mythallars* survive, and where, is unknown even to the Emporium. But Flynn and *Bastion* are now sending the *Fables* to parlay with **Larloch, the Shadow King** — the ancient lich enthroned at **Warlock's Crypt** near the *Sword Coast*. *Larloch* is said to hold the **Moon Orb**, and Flynn's company is confident the Orb is in truth a *mythallar*. The parlay is the *Fables'* next charge.

Part IV — Glossary of Characters, Factions, Places & Things

The Fables (the player characters)

The current *Fables* of Flynn are six, with a seventh counted among them in spirit.

- **Ty'Ny De'Ath** — Halfling rogue; a *Serpent* captain and the first *Fable* recruited; now bears the **Mantle of the Raven Queen**, and with it a charge to hunt the undead and any shadow that

would bend death's power to infernal ends.

- **Kaladin Tempest** — Blue-skinned druid, Master of Druids; led the retaking of Thundertree; gained new elemental mastery; carries the Mythallar home in his rucksack. Now mentors three Conservatory students of his own, and is himself sought as a successor by **Reidoth**, the High Druid of the Sword Coast.
- **Lorafina ("Lora")** — Fable of the company; pilfered gold from dead Zhentarim at the tower and helped interrogate Filz.
- **Moirra'Val** — Head Librarian and sorceress; descendant of the mortal **Wingsong bloodline**, kin to Pim by it; her master **Peer'Na** was murdered by Hamun Kost.
- **Pim** — Head Archivist; as a child she reached the sleeping Dante; now his companion. Also of Wingsong blood, kin to Moirra'Val, by the Raven Queen's own account. Records the Fables' tales with Erka Coe's feather.
- **Salihafa (Dr. Salihafa / Salihafa Tortuga)** — Cleric and Master of Divinity; returns hearing his god clearly, speaking through an alligator skull from the Marsh of Dead Men.
- **Erka Coe** — Also counted a Fable; an owl-like, plumed heroine of the early adventures (the fall of the Redbeards, the Lost Mine, the Battle of Thornhold). She now runs the **Owl's Roost Orphanage** in Neverwinter — a tower the Emporium owns — and gave Flynn the plume-feather Pim writes with.

Early companions (not among the current Fables): a human **fighter** and a strange **bird creature** picked up during the Tyl Myerda pirate-ship seizure.

The Emporium leadership (Flynn's Three Companions)



Left to right: Zoey Drake, Commander of the Serpents · Damien Wingsong, Knight Commander · Finnegan Flynn, Proprietor of the Emporium · Bastion Drake, Chief of Acquisitions

- **Finnegan Flynn** — Owner of the Emporium of Wonders; wizard "to kings and enchanter of queens." Secretly a **living dream of Jazirian**, reincarnating across ages. Rarely shows his true power outright — but did once, laying low the Circle of Flame's hidden caverns single-handed to claim the **Soulfire Forge**.
- **Bastion Drake, Esquire** — Tiefling bard, 32, twin to Zoey; Chief of Acquisitions; charming strategist and Flynn's chief correspondent. Kept the Drake name — never formally adopted — but is chosen family and equal to Flynn in all but blood.
- **Zoey Drake** — Tiefling, 32, twin to Bastion; Commander of the **Serpent Mercenaries**, Chief of Operations. Blunt, honest, and practical where Bastion charms; a rare combination of engineering and battle-tactics genius, and physically the stronger of the twins. Built the

Serpents and Thornhold's defenses from nothing; engineered the captured Soulfire Forge into the **Fables' Fortune** with her close friend Gypsa.

- **Damien Wingsong** — Dragonborn Knight Commander of the **Knights of Wingsong**; Chief of Research and Investigation; a **couatl**. Carries no Wingsong blood — took up the family's name and cause himself, believing the true bloodline extinct since Karsus's Folly. Fair, kind, strong, and gentle; the oldest of Flynn's three companions by far, and likely wiser than Flynn himself. He and his knighthood found and watched over Flynn's *potential* before this incarnation was even born, and stood guard the night of that rebirth — a story he has never told in full. Raised Bastion and Zoey in all but blood.

The Emporium's people & retainers

- **Reginald Merth** — Human Knight Captain of Wingsong; first to name the group "the Fables."
- **Newton Filz** (*deceased*) — Ex-Chancellor of the Conservatory; turned Zhentarim agent; killed at Larkspur.
- **Beratrymus Villium** — Nervous elf wizard, Master of Arcana; runs the Phandelver Field Research Outpost.
- **Derrik Lome, Tabitha Thongolir & Gregory Thorsby** — Students in the Druid's Forest at the Emporium Conservatory, studying under **Kaladin Tempest**: Derrik follows the Circle of the Land (Forest), Tabitha the Circle of Wildfire, and Gregory the Circle of the Sea.
- **Gloria Rockseeker** — General of the Serpents.
- **Gypsa** — Deep gnome engineering prodigy from Hideaway Bay; now captain of the **Fables' Fortune**. Fast friends with Zoey Drake — her undimmable joy is one of the few things that reliably softens Zoey's edges.
- **Elmar Barthen** — Phandalin trader, Emporium partner.
- **Parker Peterson** — Proprietor of the Wayfarer Inn in Southwall; discovered by Bastion running a small Triboar Trail inn and given a bigger room to be generous in. Genuinely the best innkeeper on the High Road — though he doesn't know the ale and music that made the Wayfarer famous are quietly Bastion's own touch.
- **Gerk** — Once Phandalin's town clerk, keeping his hammock-and-ledger life in the cellar jail of its Town Hall; left Phandalin with the Fables and now serves as their Quartermaster and banker. Lives in the caverns below the Citadel, quartered within the Fables' hidden headquarters near the storerooms he keeps.
- **Glorn** — A spectator, found in the Mines beneath Phandalin and satiated by the Fables; now kept beneath the Emporium Citadel, where he and **Ben Pendragon** guard the doors to the Fables' hidden headquarters.

- **Ben Pendragon** — The boy the Fables hired to care for Glorn. A naive, inexperienced stableboy — and perhaps still is — but he has a knack for keeping the beholder calm, and keeps Glorn from raging and killing mortals at the headquarters' door.

Allies & powers of the region

- **Laeral Silverhand** — Open Lord of Waterdeep, Chosen of Mystra; allied with Flynn (for now).
- **Elminster** — Archwizard; wary mentor-figure to Flynn and Bastion; tending the recovering **Mordenkainen**.
- **Sildar Hallwinter** — Retired Griffon Cavalry knight of the Lord's Alliance; recruited Flynn against the cult.
- **Reidoth** — Current High Druid of the Sword Coast; long a friend of **Qelline Alderleaf** at her farm near Phandalin, where the Fables first crossed paths with him. Has since taken an interest in **Kaladin Tempest** and seeks to mentor him as his successor.
- **Soleks Dee** — A Shadovar assassin with an unexpected streak of good in him. Sent against the Fables at the Larkspur Heath library, he broke from his mission once he realized his own team would be beaten and killed, and helped the Fables instead.
- **Raven Queen** — Deity of death, fate, and winter, who appeared to the Fables in Wingsong Tower wearing Val'Orea Wingsong's face — likely a fragment of Val'Orea's memory, trapped within the Macroscian and loosed only when it fell. She revealed that Moira'Val and Pim share Wingsong blood, and gave Ty'Ny the **Mantle of the Raven Queen** with a charge to hunt the undead and the shadow that wields them. She spoke of **Flynn** as an old, familiar acquaintance, and asked the Fables to carry her greeting to him.
- **Jazirian** — Primordial couatl-deity of law/light/mercy and a being of pure **positive energy**; Flynn is her living dream; twin of Asmodeus, whose fiendish power runs to the negative pole.

Antagonists & dark powers

- **Hariqua Na'Haran** — Fire genasi sorceress, founder of the **Circle of Flame**; illegitimate daughter of the Efreeti Sultan; bound and then betrayed by Flynn's Wish. Slaughtered the Stoneshaft dwarves of Thornhold in a failed bid to claim the keep for herself.
- **Asmodeus / Ahriman** — Archfiend of Baator; Jazirian's twin; seeks to unmake and remake the world via the broken Pact Primordial.
- **Shar** — Goddess of darkness; Asmodeus's shadow; hunted the tower via the Shadovar; now watching the Fables.
- **The Peregost** — Newly emerged leader of the **Zhentarim**.

- **Carrolyn del Thristen** (*deceased*) — Netherese archmage of Larkspur; built the tower's Infinite Planar Cyler; decayed into a **Nothic**; slain by Dante.
- **The Macroscian (Long Shadow)** (*destroyed*) — Netherese shadow-horror tethered as the tower's dark pole; slain by the Fables. Some fragment of Val'Orea Wingsong's memory may have lingered trapped within it since her death, loosed only when it finally fell.
- **Hamun Kost** — Red Wizard of Thay and necromancer; slew Moira'Val's master Peer'Na for the Wingsong book; imprisoned in Thornhold.
- **Nezznar, the Black Spider** — Drow arachnomancer; imprisoned in Waterdeep.
- **Iarno "Glasstaff" Albrek** — Lord's Alliance mage turned Redbrand leader under Nezznar's curse; sent to trial.
- **Halia Thornton** (*deceased*) — Zhentarim agent and Phandalin exchange-master; killed by the Circle of Flame.
- **Sir Bently Rhammer** (*deceased*) — Commander of the Wimbleblat force at Larkspur; killed by the Fables.
- **Lord Neebo Wimbleblat** — Patriarch of the artificing House Wimbleblat; orchestrated the Larkspur poisonings, then pivoted to building a political confederation of old-money nobles against the Emporium.
- **Val'Orea Wingsong** (*deceased*) — Mortal Lord of House Wingsong, not a couatl; slain by del Thristen defending Wingsong Manor from his siege. Some fragment of her memory may have lingered on within the Macroscian until its fall, when the Raven Queen wore her face to speak to the Fables.
- **The Dead Three** — The rising gods of murder/strife invoked in Baldur's Gate.
- **The green dragon of Thundertree** (*slain*) — Young green dragon and Circle of Flame ally that held Thundertree; killed by the Fables to free the village for the deep gnomes.
- **Larloch, the Shadow King** — Ancient Netherese lich enthroned at Warlock's Crypt, said to hold the Moon Orb; the Fables are being sent to parlay with him. Neither clearly ally nor enemy — a power unto himself. (*Emporium Conservatory archives: Larloch is one of the very few Netherese archwizards who survived Karsus's Folly under his own power rather than by del Thristen's contrivances — making him perhaps the only living witness to that age who is not a prisoner of Wingsong Tower.*)

Minor & background cast (named in the appendix, little detail given)

- **Sildar's world: Gundren Rockseeker** (dwarf who rediscovered Wave Echo Cave), **Yeemik** (Cragmaw captor).

- **Phandalin:** **Toblen Stonehill** (council chair, innkeeper), **Daran Edermath** (retired marshal), **Emily Thistleson** (guard captain, ex-Redbrand), **Roberticus Dolle** (disgraced ex-townmaster/banker), **Elmira Pebblepicker** (Redbeard), **Qelline Alderleaf**, **Sister Graele**, **Grista**.
- **Hideaway Bay:** **Chief Tackkl**, **Everitt** (marksman, Gypsa's grandfather), **Branson & Tiril** (engineers taken by yugoloths).
- **Mordenkainen** — Archwizard recovering in Storm and Laeral's care.
- **Peer'Na** (*deceased*) — Moira'Val's master; the scholar carrying the Wingsong Tower / firefly book, murdered by Hamun Kost — the killing that set the Fables on the tower's trail.
- **Unplaced portraits from the cast appendix** (roles not yet detailed in the text): **Heather Something**, **Enwyld Putnam**, **Oreeahn Thal**, **Brant Gregor**, **Martha Saxby**, **Xantha Corbert**.

Factions & groups

- **The Emporium of Wonders** — Flynn's museum/shop/power based in Waterdeep, expanding across the Sword Coast.
- **The Knights of Wingsong ("Knights of Flynn")** — Thousand-year **couatl** order sworn to keep the Mythallars safe and to protect Flynn. The order predates House Wingsong itself, having served Jazirian's cause long before the family existed; only later did it take the Wingsong name and cause as its own. Its earliest members wore the colors of the rainbow — the couatl sign — and later dwelt in the Neverwinter tower now called Owl's Roost.
- **The Serpent Mercenaries ("the Serpents")** — The Emporium's private army under Zoey.
- **The Zhentarim (Black Network)** — Mercantile-mercenary syndicate seeking monopoly; racing for the Mythallars.
- **The Circle / Cult of Flame** — Hariqua's fire cult.
- **The Lord's Alliance** — Coalition of northern rulers.
- **The Redbrands / Redbeards** — Phandalin crime syndicate (dwarven Redbeard family + Redbrand muscle), broken by the Fables.
- **The Harpers** — Covert network Bastion uses to listen for Hariqua.
- **Red Wizards of Thay** — Thayan mages (Hamun Kost's order) entangled with the Zhentarim.
- **House Wingsong** — Mortal Netherese noble house that opposed the Mythallars and was exiled from Larkspur before Karsus's Folly; raised Wingsong Manor as their seat. Its last lord, Val'Orea, died defending it from del Thrysten's siege. **Moira'Val and Pim** carry its surviving bloodline today.

- **House Wimbleblat & the Confederation** — Old Waterdeep artificing house behind the Larkspur plot; since Rhammer and Filz's deaths, Lord Neebo Wimbleblat has built a political confederation of old-money nobles (House Wands prominent among them) working to check the Emporium's rise through the Watchful Order, the Masked Lords, and rival trade offers along the High Road.
- **House Wands** — Waterdeep's historic leading house of magecraft, its wealth never fully recovered from the Spellplague; a natural, if unofficial, ally of Wimbleblat's confederation against the Emporium's newer magical prestige.
- **The Watchful Order of Magists and Protectors** — Waterdeep's body for regulating magic use in the city; the target of Wimbleblat's lobbying for a formal inquiry into the Emporium, which Bastion has so far turned to the Emporium's advantage by inviting more scrutiny, not less.
- **The Masked Lords** — Waterdeep's anonymous ruling council beneath the Open Lord; Wimbleblat courts them one at a time to build a deniable voting bloc against Emporium interests.

Places

- **Waterdeep** — Seat of the Emporium and the Lord's Alliance.
- **Thornhold Keep** — The Emporium's original northern stronghold on the High Road, its old walls now sitting eastward — nearest the road — and humbled beneath the new Citadel to the west; holds Kost in its dungeons. *(Per the Candlekeep Annals: Thornhold was raised around 952 DR, after the Second Trollwar, when the paladin Samular Caradoon routed the warlord Brunyundar Margaster from the keep. For centuries it passed hand to hand — a chapterhouse of Tyrran knights, a Caradoon family holding, and, in 1368 DR, briefly seized by the Zhentarim, who came at it through an Underdark passage and enslaved the shield dwarves of Clan Stoneshaft dwelling beneath it. Those same Stoneshaft dwarves held the keep's underground halls for generations after — until Hariqua Na'Haran slaughtered them where they stood, meaning to seize Thornhold for her own. The Emporium broke her siege too late to save them, but in doing so ended any rival claim: with the Stoneshafths gone and Margaster or Samular pretensions never enforced, the Emporium is, for the first time in Thornhold's long history, its sole undisputed holder.)*
- **The Emporium Citadel** — Flynn's new seat, raised atop the very peak of the thorn's western edge, jutting out over the sea-cliff below (the High Road and Thornhold Keep lie east, on the landward side). Pale stone, ribbed slate-dark domes, and spired towers hung with the Emporium's ten-pointed banners, linked to Southwall far below by terraced stairways carved into the cliff face. Fed by the Citadel Market Square and the Secure Warehouses at its landward

gates. The old Stoneshaft passages riddle the cliffs beneath it — re-warded by Zoey rather than sealed. One still runs, uninterrupted, into the Underdark, watched by a standing rotation of her Serpents. Another opens onto the Fables' own hidden headquarters.

- **The Fables' true, unmarked headquarters** — A hidden sea-cliff cavern beneath the Citadel, reached through the old Stoneshaft tunnels; its far wall opens directly onto the western cliff face, vast enough to dock the *Fables' Fortune*. Known to fewer people than even Flynn's own chambers; its doors are guarded by **Glorn** and **Ben Pendragon**.
- **The Citadel Market Square** — A walled plaza between Thornhold Keep and the Citadel proper, raised as the Emporium grew: master artificers, jewelers, and fine craftworkers of every kind, drawn there by Bastion's same instinct that built Southwall.
- **The Secure Warehouses** — A small, heavily walled vault-compound between the Market Square and the Citadel's landward gate, where the Emporium's magical artifacts are warded and stored.
- **The Conservatory Campus** — The Emporium Conservatory's walled home ground on the thorn's north side, adjoining the Druid's Forest; halls of arcane and divine study under Newton Filz's Conservatory framework, now overseen since his fall.
- **The Druid's Forest** — A walled wood on the thorn's north side, joined to the Conservatory Campus by a shared gate; where **Kaladin Tempest** trains **Derrik Lome**, **Tabitha Thongolir**, and **Gregory Thorsby**.
- **Phandalin** — Frontier mining town along the Triboar Trail (Stonehill Inn, Barthen's, Tresendar Manor, the Miner's Exchange, etc.); the Emporium's first proof of concept, now safeguarded by standing Serpent patrols.
- **The Triboar Trail** — Road linking Phandalin to Triboar and the High Road; Emporium-patrolled its full length, past the ruins of Conyberry.
- **Conyberry** — Near-abandoned village on the Triboar Trail; a handful of resettled families now live under a quiet Emporium stipend.
- **Triboar** — Crossroads trade town where the Long Road, Evermoor Way, and Triboar Trail meet; Bastion brokered parallel trade deals with Triboar and its rival Yartar during the hunt for Hamun Kost.
- **Yartar** — Triboar's longtime trade rival; also struck a Serpent-escort and Emporium-services deal, unaware Bastion offered Triboar the same.
- **Wave Echo Cave / Mines of Phandelver** — Lost mine and the **Forge of Spells**; now an Emporium research outpost.
- **Hideaway Bay / Tingstone** — Underdark refuge of the deep gnomes on the Shimmerlake, beset by driders and yugoloths.

- **Thundertree** — Ruined village retaken by the Fables (Kaladin leading) after they slew the **young green dragon** that held it — a Circle of Flame ally; now the deep gnomes' peaceful surface home.
- **Larkspur Heath / the Great Library at Larkspur** — Built where floating Larkspur fell; site of the poison plot.
- **Wingsong Tower** — Once **Wingsong Manor**, seat of House Wingsong, before del Thrysten besieged, claimed, and repurposed it into the Netherese watchtower it became — flickering through planes, and home to the Mythallar, the Fey and Shadow demiplanes, and the Anchor Chamber.
- **Tyl Myerda** — Magic-banning island now supplying the Emporium; site of the Oni prologue.
- **Owl's Roost (Orphanage)** — Emporium-owned tower in Neverwinter, now run by Erka Co. Long ago it housed the **early Knights of Wingsong** — monks who wore the colors of the rainbow, a sign that each was likely a **couatl**. They were among the past ages' seekers of Flynn before they vanished a generation or two ago.
- **City of Brass** — Efrete capital on the Plane of Fire; Hariqua's origin.
- **Baator** — The Nine Hells, where the injured Asmodeus/Ahriman broods.
- **The Silver Marches, the Well of Dragons, Baldur's Gate, Amn** — Sites of Bastion's five gathering storms.
- **Warlock's Crypt** — Seat of Larloch the Shadow King near the Sword Coast; the Fables' next destination, where the Moon Orb is said to rest.
- **Neverwinter** — Flynn's and the Drakes' childhood home.
- **Flynn's Folly** — The Emporium's Waterdeep gambling and counting house.
- **Southwall** — Village Bastion built from bare ground beneath Thornhold's south wall to house the citadel's workers; real streets and wells rather than a construction camp, on the theory that loyalty can't be rented by the week.
- **The Wayfarer Inn & Tavern** — Southwall's largest inn and true heart, run by **Parker Peterson**; its uncannily perfect ale and ever-present, unattributable music are quietly Bastion's own doing.
- **Flynn's Research Pocket Dimension** — A private dimension where Flynn studies fiends, devils, and beholders — beings whose powers run closest to his brother Ahriman's. He used it to prepare for the Wish and, afterward, to learn how the **Negative Energy Plane** might affect his own gifts, since as a dream of Jazirian he is tied to pure **positive energy**.
- **The Trollclaws / Troll Hills / Trollbark Forest** — Site of the first battle with Hariqua and the Wish.
- **Marsh of Dead Men** — Source of Salihafa's alligator skull.

Things & concepts

- **Mythallar** — Netherese orb of raw magic able to raise cities; its creation cleaved magic, matter, and time and frayed the **Weave**. The Emporium hunts the lost ones — though how many survive, and where, is unknown even to it.
- **The Moon Orb** — Artifact said to be held by Larloch at Warlock's Crypt; Flynn's company believes it is in truth a mythallar, and the Fables' next objective.
- **The Pact Primordial** — The primordial agreement of creation between Jazirian and Asmodeus, broken by the Mythallars; Flynn seeks to mend it.
- **Flynn's Wish** — The reality-binding wish Hariqua granted, its exact workings clouded (by divine power or the laws primordial). Flynn wished for **access to Ahriman's power** to outpace his sibling and mend the Pact first; it misfired. It now binds the brothers for the first time in an epoch — hiding Flynn from Ahriman's sight — and hints at a **missing fulcrum**, with something foreboding standing between them.
- **The Infinite Planar Cyler** — Del Thrysten's machine balancing Dante (light pole) and the Macroscian (dark pole) to draw limitless mana.
- **The Fireflies (of the Deepglow/Shimmerlake)** — Underdark species whose patterns help locate Wingsong Tower; the object of the Kost/Zhentarim race.
- **The Fables' Fortune** — The Emporium's flying ship, captained by Gypsa, now mounting the captured **Soulfire Forge** for extra raw firepower and flight speed.
- **The Soulfire Forge** — A fire-magic artifact of the Circle of Flame, seized by Flynn himself after the Fables drove Hariqua back to the Fire Plane. Zoey and Gypsa have since engineered it into the **Fables' Fortune**, giving the ship greater firepower and speed.
- **The Mantle of the Raven Queen** — Cloak gifted to Ty'Ny at Wingsong Tower, carrying a charge: to hunt the undead, and to stand against any shadow that would bend death's power to infernal ends.